WHY AN ERP MATTERS FOR AN INSURANCE AGENCY

A practical, Kenya-focused overview of how one connected system can improve service, control and growth.

Prepared for: Insurance agency leadership

1. What is an ERP?

ERP stands for **Enterprise Resource Planning**. It brings key business activities into one connected system instead of relying on separate spreadsheets, paper files and disconnected applications.

CUSTOMER & POLICY RECORDS

A central place for client details, policy information, renewals and communication history.

FINANCE & COMMISSIONS

Track premiums, commission due, receipts, expenses and reconciliations with clearer records.

WORKFLOWS & REPORTS

Assign tasks, follow up renewals, monitor claims support and see performance in one dashboard.

Simple idea: one reliable source of information for the people who need it, with access controlled by role.

2. Common challenges for agencies

When information is spread across WhatsApp, email, spreadsheets and paper files, important work can become difficult to track.

Without a connected system	What it can lead to
Renewal dates tracked manually	Missed follow-ups and avoidable lapses in cover
Client details stored in different places	Duplicate records, slow service and inconsistent information
Commission and payment records reconciled by hand	Delayed visibility into income and outstanding items
Work depends on individual staff members	Knowledge gaps when someone is absent or leaves
Reports prepared manually at month-end	Slow decisions and less time for customers

The aim is not to replace good staff or relationships. It is to reduce avoidable admin and make good service easier to deliver.

3. The business value of ERP

A well-selected and well-used ERP can help an agency improve day-to-day operations and make growth more manageable.

BETTER RENEWAL MANAGEMENT

Automated reminders and task lists help staff contact clients before policies expire.

FASTER CUSTOMER SERVICE

Staff can find customer and policy history faster, helping them answer questions consistently.

CLEARER FINANCIAL CONTROL

Reports can help reconcile premiums, receipts, commissions and outstanding balances.

MANAGEMENT VISIBILITY

Dashboards show renewal pipeline, sales activity, workload and trends without waiting for manual reports.

LESS DUPLICATE WORK

Shared records and standard processes reduce repeated data entry and lost follow-ups.

EASIER SCALE-UP

A consistent process helps the agency handle more clients, staff and branches as it grows.

4. Why it matters in the Kenyan context

An ERP should support local insurance workflows—not just generic accounting.

- **Policy and renewal tracking:** manage motor, medical, property, life or other product lines relevant to the agency.
- **Insurer and intermediary coordination:** keep a record of submissions, policy documents, endorsements and follow-up actions.
- **Kenya shilling reporting:** support KES transactions, locally useful management reports and clear reconciliation processes.
- **Data protection:** customer records may include identity, contact, financial and potentially sensitive health information. Apply role-based access, secure backups, audit logs and clear retention practices.
- **Regulatory awareness:** configure processes around the agency's actual licence, insurer agreements and applicable Insurance Regulatory Authority (IRA) requirements.

IMPORTANT

An ERP can support good record-keeping and compliance, but it does not automatically make an agency compliant. Confirm applicable obligations with the IRA and a qualified data-protection or legal adviser.

Kenya references: IRA guidance and the Office of the Data Protection Commissioner (ODPC) resources are listed on the final slide.

5. What should the agency look for?

Priority	Questions to ask a vendor
Insurance workflow fit	Can it track clients, policies, renewals, endorsements, claims follow-up and insurer interactions?
Finance & reporting	Can it handle KES, commission rules, reconciliation and reports that match our workflow?
Security & privacy	Are user permissions, audit logs, backups, recovery and secure data handling available?
Integration & support	Can it integrate with tools we already use? Is local training and support available?
Cost & flexibility	What are setup, subscription, migration, support and future upgrade costs? Can we export our data?

Suggested rollout

1. Map Document current workflows and pain points.	**2. Prioritise** Choose the must-have features.	**3. Pilot** Test with a small team or product line.	**4. Migrate & train** Clean data and train users.	**5. Measure** Review results and improve.

6. How can we tell if it is working?

Set a baseline before implementation, then review the same measures monthly. Do not assume benefits—measure them.

RENEWAL PERFORMANCE

Renewal rate; number of policies renewed before expiry; overdue follow-ups.

SERVICE SPEED

Time taken to find a record; response time; number of unresolved customer requests.

FINANCIAL VISIBILITY

Time to reconcile commissions and receipts; number of unmatched or overdue items.

TEAM PRODUCTIVITY

Hours spent on manual reports; duplicate records; tasks completed on time.

A simple business case compares the total cost of the system with measurable savings, improved retention and better control—over a realistic period.

7. Recommendation & useful references

Recommendation

Start with the agency's biggest operational pain points—often renewals, customer records, commission tracking and reporting. Choose a system that fits the agency's size, product lines, budget and data-protection responsibilities. Pilot it before rolling it out across the business.

Useful official references

- Insurance Regulatory Authority (IRA): ira.go.ke — regulator information and industry guidance.
- IRA guidelines to agents: ira.go.ke/guidelines-to-agents.
- Office of the Data Protection Commissioner (ODPC): odpc.go.ke — data protection guidance and registration information.
- ODPC data protection compliance: odpc.go.ke/data-protection-compliance.

A connected system is not just an IT upgrade—it can be a practical foundation for better service, stronger controls and sustainable growth.

Note: This presentation is for general business information, not legal, tax or regulatory advice. Confirm requirements applicable to your specific agency.